

Jubilant scenes: Arshdeep and Virat Kohli celebrated India's victory in the Men's T20 Cricket World Cup by unleashing a few *bhangra* dance moves after defeating South Africa in the final in Barbados. GETTYIMAGES

play for the country, and with all the love we receive, this is the least we can do for our fans.

When things don't go your way, how do you handle things?

Right from the start, I have learned that no matter how you fare on the field, it's important to be level-headed. It's human nature to bask in the glory after success and be in a rough state of mind when things go awry.

But you need to be calm and stay focused irrespective of the time. There are times when you might strike back on the fourth delivery and win the game for your team despite leaking runs early on. And that comeback is only possible when you have self-belief and confidence. Ultimately, it's a team game, and it's important to support all the teammates through thick and thin and enjoy every moment on the pitch.

Do you follow social media?

I would be lying if I said I don't follow social media. In today's time, it's impossible to ignore it. I follow social media and also laugh at the creativity and imagination of the people, especially because of the memes that they come up with.

Kaafi maaza aata hai woh sab dekhke (it's fun watching them), but I try to ensure it does not affect my game.

Apparently, you also have an additional role in the team now.

I'm the team's official DJ. I play a mix of Hindi, Punjabi, and English music on the team bus. Lately, we've added Mexican and Spanish tracks, including El Alfa's *La Mama De La Mama* before games. The team often suggests songs, and I choose tunes based on the mood and situation. On travel days, we go for



soothing songs, while on match days, we play upbeat tracks to boost confidence.

Coming back to the game, earlier in the conversation, you mentioned Dravid. How has this long journey been with him?

From the beginning, I've had a great bond with Rahul sir. I frequently asked him questions about the game, which has helped me improve as a cricketer.

It was rare to see him so emotional after we won the T20

World Cup. It's rewarding to see him, someone who deserves it so much, finally get a World Cup title for all his hard work. I'm glad we were able to give him a memorable farewell by winning the title.

Where do you see yourself in the next couple of years? Have you set any personal benchmarks?

I love living in the present, and that's how I approach things. I am not thinking too far ahead. I would like to contribute to my team's success and handle situations as they arise.